Colombo Consumer Price Index (CCPI)-(BASE 2021=100) September 2026

30-09-2026

Department of Census and Statistics

Ministry of Finance, Planning and Economic Development

The Department of Census and Statistics (DCS) is the authorized agency responsible for compiling the Colombo Consumer Price Index (CCPI). Following internationally accepted guidelines, the base year has been revised from 2013=100 to 2021=100 in order to accommodate changing expenditure patterns and incorporate changes in goods and services available in the market. Accordingly, with the new base year, the CCPI (Base 2021=100) has been released monthly since February 2023 on the last working day of each month. It is emphasized that index numbers or inflation figures compiled under different base years cannot be compared.

The CCPI is compiled to measure the average change in the prices of goods and services purchased by households in urban areas of the Colombo District. Price collection for the index (Base 2021=100) is carried out at 10 price collection centers located in Peliyagoda, Maradana, Wellawatta, Dematagoda, Grandpass, Kirulapone, Nugegoda, and Rathmalana, as well as at two dedicated economic centers, namely Narahenpita and Rathmalana.

Prices are collected weekly from outlets located within each of the above-mentioned market areas, including Sathosa outlets and supermarkets. The consumer basket includes 426 items, representing the typical consumption expenditure of urban households. The CPI weights are derived from the Household Income and Expenditure Survey (HIES) 2019.

- **The CCPI for all items in September 2026 stood at 209.1, recording an increase of 0.3 index points from 208.8 in August 2026.**
- **The overall rate of inflation, as measured by the CCPI on a year-on-year (Y-o-Y) basis, stood at 8.0% in September 2026.**

Content

Source Publication For more details on the revision of base year, please click here: Technical Note on Base Year Revision

1. Variations in Colombo Consumer Price Index

Month-on-month changes in the Colombo Consumer Price Index are briefly described below.

Table 1- Monthly Changes by main Groups of Market Basket

Major Group*	Index Number			Monthly Changes of the Expenditure Values (Rs.)			Monthly Changes of the Index (%)[1]		
	Sep 2025	Aug 2026	Sep 2026	Sep 2025	Aug 2026	Sep 2026	Sep 2025	Aug 2026	Sep 2026
All Items	193.7	208.8	209.1	305.94	526.15	358.48	0.17	0.28	0.19
Food and Non Alcoholic Beverages	240.1	259.8	261.0	182.17	389.40	287.03	0.10	0.20	0.15
Non Food	177.1	190.6	190.7	123.76	136.75	71.45	0.07	0.07	0.04
Alcoholic beverages Tobacco and Narcotic	250.9	248.3	249.1	-13.52	7.05	13.31	-0.01	0.00	0.01
Clothing and Footwear	254.8	258.1	258.7	6.66	30.84	15.22	0.00	0.02	0.01
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	135.4	143.0	142.9	-179.79	-104.14	-27.95	-0.10	-0.05	-0.01
Health	187.0	193.4	194.5	0.00	25.65	40.52	0.00	0.01	0.02
Transport	225.8	264.6	262.5	-118.69	-26.11	-232.20	-0.07	-0.01	-0.12
Recreation and Culture	185.0	180.5	179.3	11.63	0.00	-19.86	0.01	0.00	-0.01
Education	188.4	195.4	200.1	251.55	0.00	221.24	0.14	0.00	0.12
Restaurant and Hotels	244.5	271.7	272.6	0.00	67.40	40.01	0.00	0.04	0.02
Miscellaneous Goods and Services	197.8	210.6	211.1	18.34	39.96	14.26	0.01	0.02	0.01
Other	160.4	165.1	165.2	147.59	96.09	6.91	0.08	0.05	0.00

Note 1: There are 12 main groups of the market basket. Significant changes in September 2026 were noted in ten groups, details on which are given in Table2.
Note 2: The monthly percentage change of the index is calculated based on expenditure values.
Note 3: The percentages of items may not tally with the overall percentage due to rounding.

1.1 Month on Month (M on M) Change of CCPI:

The CCPI for all items in September 2026 stood at 209.1, recording an increase of 0.3 index points, or 0.19 percent compared to 208.8 in August 2026. This represents an increase in expenditure value of Rs.358.48 in the market basket.

1.1.1 Contribution to M-on-M Changes:

Contributions to the change in the CCPI from August 2026 to September 2026 are presented in Table 02. The Month-on-Month change was driven by an increase of 0.15% in Food items and an increase of 0.04% in Non-Food items.

1.1.2 Contribution of Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages items: 0.15%

As shown in Table 2, increases were reported for Fresh Fruits (0.14%), Big Onion (0.12%), Milk Powder (0.09%), Coconuts (0.04%), Sugar (0.03%), Potatoes (0.01%), Limes (0.01%), Bread (Normal) (0.01%), Soya meat (0.01%), Buns (0.01%) and Canned fish (Salmon) (0.01%) while decreases were reported for Sea Fish (0.13%), Green Chilly (0.11%), Vegetables (0.04%), Rice (0.02%), Eggs (0.01%), Ginger (0.01%), Chilli Powder (0.01%), Dried Fish (0.01%) and Chicken (0.01%).

1.1.3 Contribution of Non-Food items: 0.04%

Increases were recorded in the following groups of 'Education' (0.12%), 'Health' (0.02%), 'Restaurants and Hotels' (0.02%), 'Clothing and Footwear' (0.01%), 'Miscellaneous Goods and Services' (0.01%) and 'Alcoholic beverages, Tobacco and Narcotic' (0.01%) while decreases in value changes were reported for the groups of Transport' (0.12%), 'Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels' (0.01%), and 'Recreation and Culture' (0.01%).

Further, a slight price increase was reported in the group of 'Furnishing Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance'. Meanwhile, the price index of the 'Communication' group remained unchanged during the month.

Table 2: Contribution to the changes in CCPI from August 2026 to September 2026 (Base2021=100)

		Rs.Cts.	Value Change % change		
			Increase	Decrease	Net effect
Food		**287.03**	**0.49**	**0.34**	**0.15**
1	Rice	-30.32		0.02	
	Rice - (Kekulu white)	*-22.98*		*0.01*	
2	Bread (Normal)	15.04	0.01		
3	Buns	13.92	0.01		
4	Chicken	-11.91		0.01	
5	Sea Fish	-243.43		0.13	
6	Dried Fish	-12.74		0.01	
	Sprats (dry)	*-14.66*		*0.01*	
7	Canned fish (Salmon)	10.80	0.01		
8	Milk Powder	172.11	0.09		
9	Eggs	-24.95		0.01	
10	Coconuts	81.76	0.04		
11	Fresh Fruits	275.26	0.14		
	Banana	*227.50*	*0.12*		
	Mangoes	*23.64*	*0.01*		
	Oranges	*11.53*	*0.01*		
12	Vegetables	-73.03		0.04	
13	Potatoes	28.75	0.01		
14	Big Onion	227.91	0.12		
15	Green chilies	-211.59		0.11	
16	Soya meat	14.29	0.01		
17	Sugar	58.14	0.03		
18	Chilly powder	-14.48		0.01	
19	Limes	15.93	0.01		
20	Ginger	-24.25		0.01	
21	Others	19.82	0.01		
Non Food		**71.45**	**0.18**	**0.15**	**0.04**
22	Alcoholic beverages Tobacco and Narcotic	13.31	0.01		
23	Clothing and Footwear	15.22	0.01		
	Clothing	*14.37*	*0.01*		
24	Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas, and Other Fuels	-27.95		0.01	
	L. P. Gas	*-28.27*		*0.01*	
25	Health	40.52	0.02		
	Purchase of medical/ pharmacy products	*33.25*	*0.02*		
26	Transport	-232.20		0.12	
	Petrol	*-255.91*		*0.13*	
	Vehicle maintenance expenses (Repair charges)	*41.49*	*0.02*		
	Airline fare	*-16.69*		*0.01*	

27	Recreation and Culture	-19.86		0.01	
	Television	*-16.16*		*0.01*	
	Exercise books and stationeries.	*-11.41*		*0.01*	
28	Education	221.24	0.12		
	School fees (International)	*210.57*	*0.11*		
	Course fees (Higher education)	*10.67*	*0.11*		
29	Restaurant and Hotels	40.01	0.02		
30	Miscellaneous Goods and Services	14.26	0.01		
31	Others	6.91	0.00		
	All Items	**358.48**	**0.67**	**0.48**	**0.19**

*Percentages of items do not tally with overall percentage due to rounding off.

2. Inflation

The CCPI is an economic indicator constructed to measure inflation, which is defined as the percentage change in the CCPI over a period of time. There are two commonly used measures of inflation. One measure is Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y) or Point-to-Point inflation, which is the percentage change in the CCPI over the previous 12 months. The other measure is Moving Average Inflation, which is the percentage difference between the average CCPI of the latest 12 months and the average CCPI of the preceding 12 months.

Table 03: Movements of the CCPI (Base: 2021=100)

Year	Month	All Item				Food				Non-Food			
		Index Number	% Change Month on Month	Inflation %		Index Number	% Change Month on Month	Inflation %		Index Number	% Change Month on Month	Inflation %	
				Y on Y	12 Month Moving Avg.			Y on Y	12 Month Moving Avg.			Y on Y	12 Month Moving Avg.
2025	September	193.7	0.2	1.5	-1.4	240.1	0.3	2.9	1.4	177.1	0.1	0.7	-2.7
	October	193.8	0.1	2.1	-1.2	240.0	0.0	3.5	1.6	177.4	0.2	1.4	-2.5
	November	193.4	-0.2	2.1	-0.8	238.6	-0.6	3.0	1.8	177.3	-0.1	1.7	-2.1
	December	195.8	1.2	2.1	-0.5	247.9	3.9	3.0	2.0	177.3	0.0	1.8	-1.7
2026	January	197.0	0.6	2.3	0.0	249.4	0.6	3.3	2.5	178.3	0.6	1.8	-1.1
	February	195.3	-0.9	1.6	0.5	242.9	-2.6	0.2	2.6	178.3	0.0	2.3	-0.4
	March	195.8	0.3	2.2	0.9	240.9	-0.8	0.7	2.6	179.7	0.8	2.9	0.2
	April	201.6	3.0	5.4	1.6	245.1	1.7	2.8	2.7	186.2	3.6	6.8	1.0
	May	203.4	0.9	5.5	2.1	247.1	0.8	0.9	2.3	187.9	0.9	7.8	2.0
	June	207.7	2.1	6.8	2.7	258.2	4.5	3.6	2.3	189.7	1.0	8.4	2.9
	July	208.2	0.2	7.3	3.3	258.2	0.0	6.3	2.7	190.4	0.4	7.8	3.7
	August	208.8	0.3	8.0	3.9	259.8	0.6	8.5	3.2	190.6	0.1	7.7	4.3
	September	209.1	0.1	8.0	4.5	261.0	0.5	8.7	3.7	190.7	0.1	7.7	4.8

Note: Year on Year inflation, 12 Month Moving Average inflation and Month on Month change were calculated using the rounding off index numbers

2.1 Year on Year (Y-on-Y) Inflation

The overall rate of inflation, as measured by the CCPI on a Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y) basis, stood at 8.0% in September 2026, compared to 8.0% in August 2026 (Table 03). The Y-o-Y inflation for the Food Group increased to 8.7% in September 2026 from 8.5% in August 2026, and the Y-o-Y inflation for the Non-Food Group remained unchanged in September 2026 at 7.7% which was reported in August 2026.

2.2 Contribution to Y-on-Y inflation:

For the month of September 2026, on Y-on-Y basis, the contribution to inflation by food commodities was 2.83 percentage points.

The contribution of Non-Food items was 5.16%. This was mainly driven by increases in the price indices of 'Transport' (2.38%), 'Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels' (1.22%), 'Restaurants and Hotels' (0.74%), 'Education' (0.31%), 'Miscellaneous Goods and Services' (0.22%), 'Health' (0.15%), 'Furnishing Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance' (0.14%), 'Clothing and Footwear' (0.05%) and 'Communication' (0.02%) while price decreases were reported for the groups of 'Recreation and Culture' (0.06%) and 'Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics' (0.01%).

Table 04: Contribution to the changes in CCPI (Base 2021=100) year on year basis September 2026 as compared to September 2025

Sub Group/Commodity	Value	Increase	Decrease	Net
	Rs.Cts.	%	%	%
Food and Non Alcoholic Beverages	**5031.31**			**2.83**
Rice	-288.36		0.16	
Bread (Normal)	51.16	0.03		
Buns	49.57	0.03		
Chicken	166.24	0.09		
Beef	29.39	0.02		
Sea fish	1439.16	0.81		
Dried Fish	627.45	0.35		
Milk powder	418.12	0.23		
Infant milk powder	40.41	0.02		
Yoghurt	79.55	0.04		
Eggs	224.31	0.13		
Coconuts	-535.25		0.30	
Fresh Fruits	623.79	0.35		
Vegetable	524.18	0.29		
Potatoes	14.52	0.01		
Dhal Mysoor	-25.85		0.01	
Red Onions	64.14	0.04		
Big Onions	514.85	0.29		
Green chilies	345.99	0.19		
Sugar	47.98	0.03		
Ice-cream	89.35	0.05		
Chilly powder	131.88	0.07		
Dried chilies	232.77	0.13		
Salt	-30.20		0.02	
Turmeric powder	-31.84		0.02	
Limes	-101.55		0.06	
Tea dust	-81.09		0.05	
NON-FOOD	**9188.25**			**5.16**
Alcoholic beverages Tobacco and Narcotic	-26.58		0.01	
Arrack	*10.69*	*0.01*		
Beetle leaves	*-42.31*		*0.02*	
Areca nuts	*10.62*	*0.01*		

Clothing and Foot Wear	81.47	0.05	
Clothing	*78.23*	*0.04*	
Shoes	*9.70*	*0.01*	
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	2175.54	1.22	
Housing rent	*921.89*	*0.52*	
Materials for Maintenance	*284.31*	*0.16*	
Electricity	*340.68*	*0.19*	
L. P. Gas	*497.84*	*0.28*	
Kerosene oil	*130.81*	*0.07*	
Furnishing Household Equipment and Routine	252.12	0.14	
Washing soap	*38.67*	*0.02*	
Washing powder	*72.41*	*0.04*	
Detergents	*23.65*	*0.01*	
Dish wash liquid	*11.91*	*0.01*	
Health	274.80	0.15	
Purchase of medical/ pharmacy products	*30.88*	*0.02*	
Fees to private medical practices	*83.18*	*0.05*	
Consultation fees to specialists	*100.12*	*0.06*	
Payments. to medical laboratories	*24.80*	*0.01*	
Transport	4241.47	2.38	
Motor Cars	*358.92*	*0.20*	
Three Wheelers	*8.98*	*0.01*	
Petrol	*2325.90*	*1.31*	
Diesel	*296.38*	*0.17*	
Lubricating oil	*111.54*	*0.06*	
Cost of servicing of vehicles	*244.25*	*0.14*	
Vehicle maintenance expenses (Repair charges)	*41.49*	*0.02*	
Bus fare	*475.00*	*0.27*	
Three wheelers fare	*59.66*	*0.03*	
Transport for schooling/pre schooling	*239.76*	*0.13*	
Airline fare	*27.63*	*0.02*	
Communication	30.71	0.02	
Telephones	*22.47*	*0.01*	
Recreation and Culture	-101.64		0.06
Television	*-80.79*		*0.05*
Exercise books and stationeries.	*-28.74*		*0.02*
Education	550.78	0.31	
Tuition fees	*92.19*	*0.05*	
School fees (International)	*210.57*	*0.12*	
Course fees (Higher education)	*220.10*	*0.12*	
Course fees (vocational training)	*27.91*	*0.02*	
Restaurant and hotels	1318.74	0.74	
Miscellaneous Goods and Services	390.82	0.22	
Hair cutting and shaving charges	*42.99*	*0.02*	
Tooth paste	*9.25*	*0.01*	
Face cream and lotions	*14.04*	*0.01*	
Hair oils, creams	*29.74*	*0.02*	
Hand bags/ Traveling bags	*74.63*	*0.04*	
Insurance/ Agrahara	*203.49*	*0.11*	
All Items	14219.56		7.99

*Percentages of items do not tally with overall percentage due to rounding off.

Movements in the CCPI (Base 2021=100) for Head Line, Food, Non-Food and Year on Year Inflation

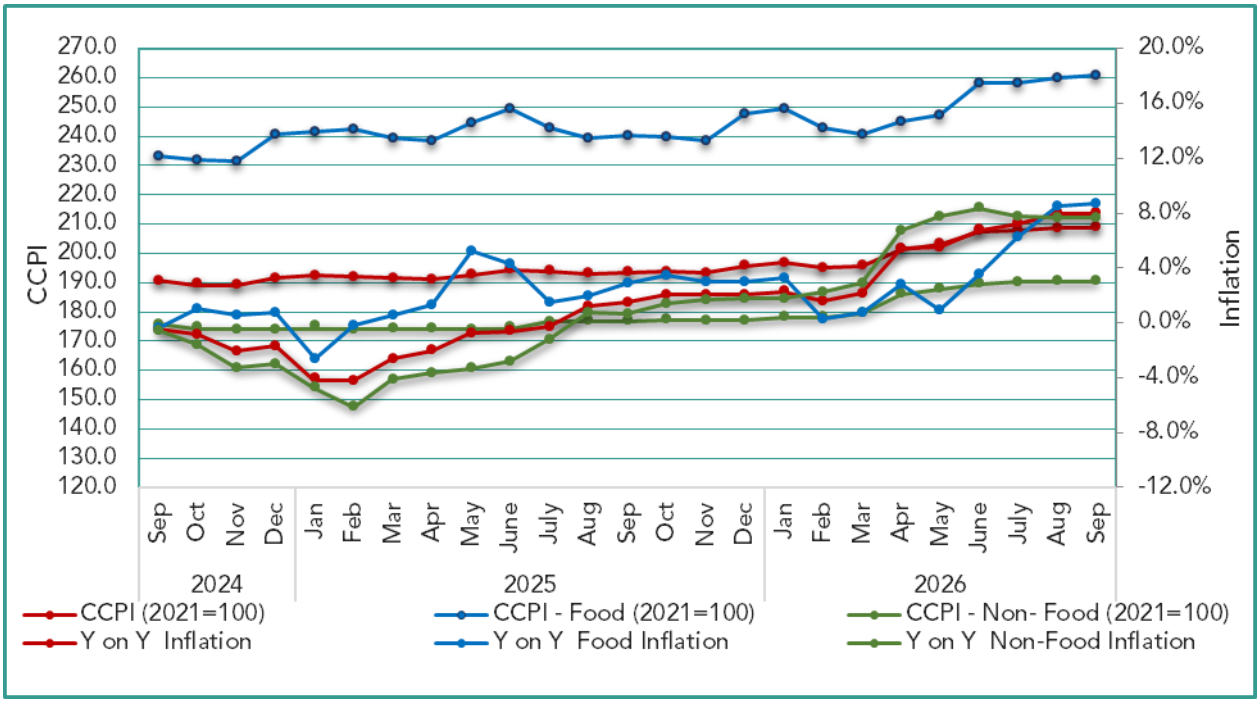


Table 05: Monthly average open market retail prices of selected items of Colombo Consumer Price Index September 2025, August 2026 & September 2026

Item	Unit	Retail Prices (Rs. Cts)			Retail Price Changes (%)	
		2025 September	2026 August	2026 September	Sep. 26/ Sep. 25	Sep. 26/ Aug. 26
1. Rice -Kekulu - Red	Kg	203.77	191.41	190.31	-0.07	-0.01
2. Rice - Kekulu - White	Kg	213.67	207.56	204.23	-0.04	-0.02
3. Rice - Nadu - White	Kg	227.49	225.25	224.73	-0.01	0.00
4. Rice - Nadu - Red	Kg	236.51	227.32	229.80	-0.03	0.01
5. Rice - Samba	Kg	258.10	243.95	243.96	-0.05	0.00
6. Cowpea	Kg	1079.49	897.38	891.08	-0.17	-0.01
7. Green Grams	Kg	991.79	916.25	896.41	-0.10	-0.02
8. Coconut	Each	194.15	165.46	169.26	-0.13	0.02
9. Coconut Oil	750ml	680.09	671.74	671.77	-0.01	0.00
10. Chicken	Kg	1258.02	1335.60	1330.41	0.06	0.00
11. Eggs	Each	31.91	44.71	43.43	0.36	-0.03
12. Red Onion	Kg	375.95	456.74	458.96	0.22	0.00
13. Big Onion	Kg	161.40	242.62	307.13	0.90	0.27
14. Potatoes	Kg	300.44	293.79	307.23	0.02	0.05
15. Garlic	Kg	546.97	561.49	573.65	0.05	0.02
16. Dried Chilies	Kg	814.58	1304.03	1307.82	0.61	0.00
17. Green Chilies	Kg	414.21	1414.12	1034.67	1.50	-0.27
18. Sugar	Kg	236.34	233.59	249.31	0.05	0.07
19. Pepper	Kg	2854.06	2982.81	2958.55	0.04	-0.01
Vegetables						
20. Ash Plantain	Kg	212.24	284.47	286.86	0.35	0.01
21. Carrot	Kg	428.88	437.56	418.95	-0.02	-0.04
22. Snake Gourd	Kg	339.46	437.80	434.69	0.28	-0.01
23. Tomatoes	Kg	236.79	491.70	484.78	1.05	-0.01

24. Capsicum	Kg	542.73	602.97	585.96	0.08	-0.03
25. Beetroot	Kg	260.86	502.24	431.71	0.65	-0.14
26. Beans	Kg	524.92	531.55	564.89	0.08	0.06
Fruits						
27. Banana	Kg	262.91	249.33	268.19	0.02	0.08
28. Papaw	Kg	199.82	279.49	283.21	0.42	0.01
29. Mangoes	Each	338.86	175.06	193.60	-0.43	0.11
Fresh Fish						
30. Seer	Kg	4141.66	4370.38	4353.27	0.05	0.00
31.Talapath	Kg	2822.87	3263.34	3274.99	0.16	0.00
32.Paraw	Kg	2744.70	3276.40	3238.63	0.18	-0.01
Dried Fish						
33.Katta	Kg	2419.71	3260.36	3259.60	0.35	0.00
34. Sprats	Kg	1425.02	2080.40	2053.34	0.44	-0.01
Fuel						
35. Kerosene Oil	Lt	185.00	285.00	285.00	0.54	0.00
36. Petrol (CPC & IOC)	Lt	300.50	414.00	402.75	0.34	-0.03
37. Diesel (CPC & IOC)	Lt	284.50	382.00	382.00	0.34	0.00
38. Gas- Avg.	12.5kg	3792.50	4590.00	4547.14	0.20	-0.01
Litro	12.5kg	3690.00	4465.00	4407.86	0.19	-0.01
Laughs	12.5kg	4100.00	4965.00	4965.00	0.21	0.00

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